

Backup & Business Continuity Checklist

Confirm whether your business can recover from ransomware, deletion, outage, or device loss.

Purpose

Backups are not the same as recoverability. This checklist helps determine whether a business can actually recover from ransomware, accidental deletion, system failure, cloud account compromise, or a site-level outage.

Backup & BCDR Review

Critical Data	Do you know which systems and files must be recovered first?	Yes / No / Unknown
Endpoint Backup	Are user devices backed up where business data exists locally?	Yes / No / Unknown
Cloud Data	Are Microsoft 365, Google Workspace, or other cloud data sources backed up separately?	Yes / No / Unknown
Server/Systems	Are business-critical systems backed up with documented retention?	Yes / No / Unknown
Recovery Testing	Has a restore been tested in the last 90 days?	Yes / No / Unknown
Ransomware Readiness	Are backups protected from deletion or encryption by compromised accounts?	Yes / No / Unknown
Recovery Time	Do you know how long the business can be down before real damage occurs?	Yes / No / Unknown
Recovery Point	Do you know how much data loss is acceptable?	Yes / No / Unknown
Documentation	Is the recovery process documented and assigned to responsible parties?	Yes / No / Unknown

Business Recovery Terms

- RTO: Recovery Time Objective - how long the business can tolerate downtime.
- RPO: Recovery Point Objective - how much data the business can afford to lose.
- BCDR: Business Continuity and Disaster Recovery - the strategy for keeping the business operating during disruption.

Recommended Next Step

If restore testing, cloud backup, or recovery ownership is unclear, request a Backup & Business Continuity review before assuming the business is protected.

CTA: Request a Backup & BCDR review before assuming recovery will work.